Question 2: Long Essay Question, Native American Societies and European Colonists — 6 points

General Scoring Notes

- Except where otherwise noted, each point of these rubrics is earned independently; for example, a student could earn a point for evidence without earning a point for thesis/claim.
- **Accuracy:** The components of these rubrics require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, essays may contain errors that do not detract from their overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- **Clarity:** Exam essays should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and practices described below.

Evaluate how Native American societies adapted to the presence of European colonists in North America from 1500 to 1754.

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row A **Thesis/Claim** **(0–1 points)**	**0 points** Does not meet the criteria for one point.	**1 point** Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: • Are not historically defensible. • Only restate or rephrase the prompt. • Do not respond to the prompt. • Do not establish a line of reasoning. • Are overgeneralized.	**Responses that earn this point:** • Provide a historically defensible thesis or claim about how Native American societies adapted to the presence of European colonists in North America from 1500 to 1754. The thesis or claim must either provide some indication of the reason for making that claim OR establish categories of the argument.
	Examples that do not earn this point: **Provide a restatement of the prompt** • *"Native American societies adapted to the presence of European colonists in North America."* **Provide a historically defensible claim, but do not establish a line of reasoning** • *"Native Americans adapted to Europeans in many ways."* **Are not historically defensible** • *"Native Americans didn't adapt to the presence of Europeans."*	**Examples that earn this point:** **Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt** • *"While some Native Americans often sought alliances with Europeans to improve their regional power position, others sought alliances with other Native nations to prevent the expansion of European colonies."* **Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt with analytic categories** • *"Native Americans adapted to Europeans by seeking out some European goods, while also reinforcing some aspects of their traditional culture."* **Establish a line of reasoning** • *"The introduction of new diseases forced Native Americans to rebuild their societies."* • *"Native Americans adapted by trading furs with Europeans."* [Minimally acceptable thesis/claim]
	Additional Notes: • The thesis or claim must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion (which may not be limited to the first or last paragraphs). • The thesis or claim must identify a relevant development(s) in the period, although it is not required to encompass the entire period.	

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row B Contextualization **(0–1 points)**	**0 points** Does not meet the criteria for one point.	**1 point** Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: • Provide an overgeneralized statement about the time period referenced in the prompt. • Provide context that is not relevant to the prompt. • Provide a passing phrase or reference.	**Responses that earn this point:** • Accurately describe a context relevant to Native American societies and the presence of European colonists in North America from 1500 to 1754**.**
	Examples that do not earn this point: **Do not provide context relevant to the topic of the prompt** • *"Colonists issued the Declaration of Independence because they were sick and tired of taxes."* **Provide a passing phrase or reference** • *"There were a wide variety of Native American cultures before the arrival of Europeans."*	**Examples of relevant context that earn this point include the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided:** • Native American societies prior to contact with Europeans • Pre-contact trade between Native American nations • European transoceanic ventures • Christopher Columbus • Conflict between Protestants and Catholics in Europe • Native American participation in the American Revolution • Native American relations with the United States government **Example of acceptable contextualization:** • *"Many Native American societies had maize-based agriculture, which contributed to trade networks that stretched across the Americas."* • *"Columbus landed in the Americas in 1492 which led to colonization in Mexico and South America."* [Minimally acceptable contextualization]
	Additional Notes: • The response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the question that are relevant to the topic of the prompt. • To earn this point, the context provided must be more than a phrase or reference.	

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row C **Evidence** **(0–2 points)**	**0 points** Does not meet the criteria for one point.	**1 point** Provides specific examples of at least **two** pieces of evidence relevant to the **topic** of the prompt.	**2 points** Supports an **argument** in response to the prompt using at least **two** pieces of specific and relevant evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: • Identify a single piece of evidence. • Provide evidence that is not relevant to the topic of the prompt. • Provide evidence that is outside the time period or region specified in the prompt. • Repeat information that is specified in the prompt. **Examples that do not earn points:** **Provide evidence that is outside the time period or region specified in the prompt** • *"Cahokia was an important Native American city in the Mississippi River region."*	**Responses that earn 1 point:** • Identify at least two specific historical examples relevant to Native American societies and the presence of European colonists in North America from 1500 to 1754. **Examples of evidence that are specific and relevant include the following (two examples required):** • Columbian Exchange • Encomienda • Casta system • Powhatan • Pocahontas • Fur trade • Métis people • Native alliances with Europeans [e.g., Haudenosaunee "Covenant Chain" with the British] • Pueblo Revolt / Popé's Rebellion • Pequot War • Metacom's [King Philip's] War • Bartolomé de las Casas • Mission settlements • Imperial wars [King William's War, Queen Anne's War, King George's War] • British colonial regions [New England, middle colonies, southern colonies] **Example of a statement that earns one point for evidence:** • *"Partly due to the influence of Catholic figures such as Bartolomé de las Casas, the Spanish monarch passed laws in the mid-1500s to regulate the encomienda and the general treatment of Native Americans."*	**Responses that earn 2 points:** • Use at least two specific historical examples to support an argument regarding how Native American societies adapted to the presence of European colonists in North America from 1500 to 1754. **Examples that successfully support an argument with evidence:** • *"Indigenous people adapted to the presence of Europeans by engaging with them commercially, such as through the fur trade, and forming alliances, such as the Covenant Chain between the Haudenosaunee Confederacy and the British."* [Uses evidence to support an argument about how Indigenous people adapted by engaging in commerce and diplomacy with Europeans] • *"Mission settlements, such as those in established in New France, saw thousands of Indigenous inhabitants adopting the Christian faith, while other Native groups resisted European incursions through conflicts such as Metacom's War."* [Uses evidence to support an argument about how Native American societies both accommodated and resisted European colonists] • *"Native Americans altered their lifestyles in response to the Columbian Exchange through developments such as adopting horses for buffalo hunting and trading traditional foodstuffs, such as corn, beans, and squash, with European colonists for manufactured goods like pots and hatchets."* [Uses evidence to support an argument about how Native Americans altered their lifestyles in response the Columbian Exchange]

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	Additional Notes: • Typically, statements credited as evidence will be more specific than statements credited as contextualization. • If a response has a multipart argument, then it can meet the threshold of two pieces of evidence by giving one example for one part of the argument and another example for a different part of the argument, but the total number of examples must still be at least two.

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row D Analysis and Reasoning Complex Understanding (0–2 points)	**0 points** Does not meet the criteria for one point.	**1 point** Uses historical reasoning [e.g. comparison, causation, continuity and change] to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.	**2 points** Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: • May include evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument. • May assert the use of historical reasoning but does not use it to frame or structure an argument.	**Responses that earn 1 point:** • Must demonstrate the use of historical reasoning to frame or structure an argument about how Native American societies adapted to the presence of European colonists in North America from 1500 to 1754. The reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking specificity.	**Responses that earn 2 points:** May demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: • Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR • Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR • Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR • Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. May demonstrate a complex understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways that might include: • Explaining how multiple pieces of specific and relevant evidence [at least **four**] support a nuanced or complex argument that responds to the prompt; OR • Using evidence effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt.
	Examples that do not earn points: **Provide evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument category** • *"British settlers founded Jamestown."*	**Using a historical reasoning process to frame or structure an argument could include:** • Explaining how the treatment of Native Americans by the Spanish and the treatment of Native Americans by the French led to differences in how different Native groups responded to colonization. • Explaining how the introduction of new manufactured goods into North America altered Native American societies and politics. **Example of acceptable use of historical reasoning:** • *"Many Native Americans participated as subjects of the Spanish Empire, while in the French Empire most asserted their rights as independent sovereign*	**Demonstrating a complex understanding might include any of the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided:** • A response may argue that Native Americans adapted to the European presence by incorporating aspects of European culture into their societies. It then provides multiple pieces of specific and relevant evidence, including the adoption of aspects of Christianity by Native peoples in Mexico and South America, the incorporation of horses into buffalo hunting by Native peoples on the Great Plains, the participation of Native peoples in eastern North America in the fur trade with the Dutch, French, and British, and the incorporation of metal tools and firearms into domestic work and warfare by Native peoples across the Americas. [Explains how at least four pieces of evidence support a nuanced or complex argument]

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		allies." [Indicates a difference between how Native Americans adapted to Spanish colonialism and how they adapted to French colonialism]	• A response may compare the responses of Native American societies to European empires in different regions across North America, arguing that the different social and economic structures of the Aztec people of Mexico, compared to Algonquian peoples of eastern North America, led to differing adaptations to colonization. The more centrally organized Aztec empire was conquered and incorporated into the Spanish empire, while the more decentralized Native American groups of eastern North America remained independent from European colonies and maintained their sovereignty. [Explains relevant connections across geographical areas]
	Additional Notes: • To earn the first point for analysis and reasoning, the response must use historical reasoning to structure a response to the prompt, although the reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking in specificity. • This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. • While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference.		

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